For instance, a binary function `f` that has a default value for the the second argument could be called with either 2 arguments, something like `f(5,3)`, or just one: in that case, for instance `f(5)` is the same as calling `f(5,2)`.

Default arguments allow a compact syntax for overloading functions and methods.

Since we are using a loosely-typed approach, this is the only king of overloading we need or even can perform (while in strongly-typed languages like C++ or Java, we would need to overload functions for which an argument can either be an integer or a string or...).

A.6.2 Tuples

Sometimes we need functions to return more than one value. To make things easy for us, we assume that functions can return tuples.

A tuple is similar to an array, although slightly different:

1. It's a list of values with a fixed length (while arrays can grow or shrink);
2. Its elements can have any type, and tuples can hold different types at the same time.

Tuples are denoted using parenthesis: `(1,2)` is a tuple of length two (aka a *pair*) whose elements are numbers with values `1` and `2`.